

SEH needs to be trained to identify spam mails, and all mails are initially categorised as “Unsure”. The user needs to correctly classify the “Unsure” e-mails as “spam” or “not spam” before SEH correctly identifies them automatically. This classification is in addition to the permitted or blocked e-mail sender classification.

5.8.3 SpamBayes 1.0.4

<http://spambayes.sourceforge.net>

If you use a desktop e-mail program like Outlook and are drowning in spam, then you will love SpamBayes. Derived from the work of Internet stalwart Paul Graham, SpamBayes’ approach to killing spam is by using sophisticated statistical algorithms that score each message based on keywords in the text. This is somewhat similar to what other anti-spam programs do (commercial or free) but with one difference. The SpamBayes team uses some significantly different methods (maths students who are curious to find out more, go to <http://spambayes.sourceforge.net/background.html>) that yield better results.

If you use Outlook, there is a plugin available that will directly integrate with SpamBayes. If you use a different POP3 client like Mozilla Thunderbird, SpamBayes sits between it and your POP3 server to filter and process messages.

SpamBayes classifies all messages as spam, ham (good mail) and “unsure.” Initially, you need to train SpamBayes to differentiate between spam and ham. Once trained, SpamBayes will shift all present and future spam and unsure messages to separate folders which you can then review and delete at your leisure.

SpamBayes has extremely high accuracy—98–100 per cent over time. The number of false positives gradually drops, and eventually you may even forget that SpamBayes is working!